



Start-up guide

With Modi encouraging India for start-ups, here's the roadmap for pitching the startup idea in your mind
<http://dgit.in/StartupGuide>



Google pays Apple?

Google paid a big chunk of money to Apple, to be the default search engine for iOS.
<http://dgit.in/PayApple>

Industry Connect



Third-party app stores are here to stay

We sit down with Co-founder and CEO of Mauj Mobile to learn how their app stores cater to the Indian audience



◀ **Badri Sanjeevi**
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You have 3 properties Mobango, Games Bond and AppyStore. How are your platforms different from existing ones like Amazon's AppStore, SlideME and GetJar?

Badri: To be very honest I don't know if GetJar and SlideME are still alive. GetJar shut down and was sold to a Chinese company, I don't know if they still operate. Haven't seen that in a couple of years now. SlideME also I am not sure, maybe they do operate. I have to understand what that is. Let's step back a little and look at Mauj Mobile. It's a company that operates in two verticals, one is gaming and the other is kid's edutainment. Another objective for us is to offer highly segmented content which have been curated. And the segments that we look at are very large with very large underlying market place. Today, if a user wants content they predominantly go to Google Play and YouTube, and we know that these platforms are pretty inefficient when it comes to offering highly curated content. What I mean by curated is, for example, if you go to AppyStore it will show content only for children below the age of eight. We have done a lot of work with teachers and experts for understanding what are the major developmental areas and milestones for children. You will find that the content is absolutely right for

the child and the parent. If you go to our app in Google Play you will see that the feedback and rating from parents is exactly what we hoped to see. Parents find this as a great resource for their children and they also find that the app engagement is very high because it's solving the problem for the end user. Similarly, on gaming what we are building and hoping to receive the whole 150 million gamers who are in India. We want to provide the gamers with an amazing gaming experience. Not throw at them 200,000 apps that Google Play may have, but throw at them a set of curated apps, across the most popular categories and each game is a good game with levels, depths and proper curation.

Why make Gamesbond, a new platform for premium games, and why not incorporate premium games into the existing platform - Mobango?

Badri: It is happening already happening in many ways.

Often there's a certain stigma attached to third-party App stores. I'm not pointing the finger at your app store but there is the general view that third party app stores are where those apps land which don't make the cut on native stores. How do you respond to that?

Badri: No, I think that's not right. In terms of numbers there is no stigma. What I am

saying is if you look at the numbers, we think that three billion game downloads happen in India in a year. And roughly half is delivered by Google Play and the other half is delivered by everything else so there is no stigma. Who are the biggest people in the other half? It's Opera AppStore, UC browsers AppStore and Mobango AppStore which are all alternate app stores. If you go and talk to 10-15 gamers like we do every week with 5-6 gamers, you would find out that people are extremely comfortable going wherever they need to go to discover the content. There is no stigma, they know and understand how to download an APK, and know how to discern a good product from a bad product. So the customer is more sophisticated. So the stigma thing is not right.

For example, could you say at any given time there is stigma in watching a video in HotStar because it's not on YouTube? Or is there stigma in watching something on Spuul or Hungama and not on YouTube. It was never the case, so why is there stigma in an executable file and not on a mpeg video, it is all what we have built up in our minds as analysts. So there was never a stigma in watching a video from wherever, also today people have started watching video on Snapchat and Facebook. So seeing as what Snapchat is based on, I think those are just misconceptions and the numbers don't reflect on what is ascertained to have